JETRO Business Brief dated 2026/10/28

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[GLOBAL]

◇World direct investment in first half of 2026 up 37%, new projects decline—UNCTAD report (Global)
●International Economics Division, Research Department
https://www.jetro.go.jp/biznews/2026/10/098836fa1b1fdf18.html

[ASIA-OCEANIA]

◇Dongguan-based China Baoli Wei strengthens strategic partnership with Vietnam's VinFast (China, Vietnam)
●Guangzhou Bureau
https://www.jetro.go.jp/biznews/2026/10/b43579c28ba0c289.html

◇China's January-September GDP growth rate at 4.6%, maintaining stable growth despite continued cooling in investment (China)
●Beijing Bureau
https://www.jetro.go.jp/biznews/2026/10/b67c3d048daa881c.html

◇China to implement hydrogen energy comprehensive utilization pilot projects in five urban clusters (China)
●Wuhan Bureau
https://www.jetro.go.jp/biznews/2026/10/6dca1c8c4735bc4d.html

◇South Korean government announces regulatory streamlining measures to support startup growth (South Korea)
●Seoul Bureau
https://www.jetro.go.jp/biznews/2026/10/dab9e60a7bd856fd.html

◇"ASEAN Energy Outlook" released—final consumption expected to expand up to fourfold by 2060 (ASEAN)
●Bangkok Bureau
https://www.jetro.go.jp/biznews/2026/10/676a92b0a08d914a.html

◇Impact of reduced natural gas supply from Indonesia limited—Singapore government explains (Singapore, Indonesia)
●Singapore Bureau
https://www.jetro.go.jp/biznews/2026/10/68437dd18ccd0690.html

◇Singapore government considers diversifying LNG procurement sources and utilizing nuclear and geothermal energy; announces power infrastructure development plan (Singapore)

●Singapore Bureau
https://www.jetro.go.jp/biznews/2026/10/039fa507e2d10747.html

◇Thai health, wellness, and elderly care sector operators introduce cooperation needs with Japanese companies (Thailand, Japan)
●Bangkok Bureau
https://www.jetro.go.jp/biznews/2026/10/b10b055e5e2e8d0c.html

◇Thailand Commerce Ministry begins accepting public comments on tariff quota standards for tea, coffee, and other products (Thailand)
●Bangkok Bureau
https://www.jetro.go.jp/biznews/2026/10/795677f1b3e664d8.html

◇Thai Health Ministry calls for compliance with new notification on packaged food labeling (Thailand)
●Bangkok Bureau
https://www.jetro.go.jp/biznews/2026/10/befbcc7c27f235a8.html

◇January-September trade volume reaches record high, up 30.1% from previous year (Malaysia)
●Kuala Lumpur Bureau
https://www.jetro.go.jp/biznews/2026/10/18441a9971a8922e.html

◇2027 fiscal year national budget submitted; minimum wage to increase to 2,000 ringgit (Malaysia)
●Kuala Lumpur Bureau
https://www.jetro.go.jp/biznews/2026/10/123db2e6c38c9057.html

◇JASSO holds study abroad fair with over 2,000 visitors—highest attendance since pandemic (Vietnam, Japan)
●Hanoi Bureau
https://www.jetro.go.jp/biznews/2026/10/df5ebcd5fbca3606.html

◇India GST Council approves input tax credit for group insurance (India)
●Mumbai Bureau
https://www.jetro.go.jp/biznews/2026/10/73f6f9cd545e49df.html

◇Singapore's CapitaLand opens data center in Chiang Mai (Thailand)
●Chiang Mai Bureau
https://www.jetro.go.jp/biznews/2026/10/c4eb38c923597949.html

◇Bangladesh's first nuclear power plant targets transmission of approximately 300MW starting in November (Bangladesh, Russia)
●Dhaka Bureau
https://www.jetro.go.jp/biznews/2026/10/176df5f85de805f4.html

[NORTH AMERICA, LATIN AMERICA]

◇Asahi Refining USA opens new silver refining facility in Utah (United States, Japan)
●Los Angeles Bureau
https://www.jetro.go.jp/biznews/2026/10/a52073e2b48ba0c1.html

◇JETRO dispatches inspection mission on semiconductor and data center industry ecosystem to Arizona (United States, Japan)
●Los Angeles Bureau
https://www.jetro.go.jp/biznews/2026/10/d07753b4d78aa1dc.html

◇One week until U.S. midterm elections; close races continue in battleground states including Maine—poll (United States)
●Americas Division, Research Department
https://www.jetro.go.jp/biznews/2026/10/767f98909fa6f302.html

◇Third round of government-opposition dialogue achieves agreement on four legal reforms to expand political participation (Venezuela)
●Caracas Bureau
https://www.jetro.go.jp/biznews/2026/10/0161fc00faadb88a.html

◇President Lula wins runoff in Brazil presidential election for reelection (Brazil)
●São Paulo Bureau
https://www.jetro.go.jp/biznews/2026/10/628dc86f209ff1b1.html

◇Argentine government refrains from issuing statement on President Lula's reelection